

Attendance Rapport for Computer Vision in Archaeology - Training School 2026

Kristoffer Tekiela Sørensen

Aarhus Universitet

Afdeling for Arkæologi og Kulturarvsstudier

I would like to start off by showing appreciation for the opportunity to attend the summer school, made possible by ATRIUM, and to the incredible and engaging team at the Institute of Archaeology, Czech Academy of Sciences, Brno. I attended the summer school from 14 to 18 September 2026.

As a master student studying Historical Archaeology at Aarhus University, Denmark, I was motivated to apply for this summer school to help me conceptualise new ideas for my upcoming thesis. This week has been an incredible resource and help to further that goal.

Remote sensing as a discipline in archaeology is still an emerging area in Danish research. There is a lot of available data, free to use for research, which has not been analysed through new methods involving computer vision. It was with this mindset that I applied for the Summer School to explore the opportunities which computer vision has to offer.

The intense five-day course introduced different datasets (Artefacts, Microscopic images, Satellite, Rock art & Coins) that can be used as the foundation for different methods and models, which were introduced in the course's theory sections. Every day was something different, the usual template was theory in the morning and practical applications in the afternoon. For my thesis research, the work with annotations (from Tuesday's lecture) helped me realise the potential that modern tools offer, this was done with Meta's SAM2/3. This was accompanied with an introduction to formats for detection (COCO, YOLO, Pascal VOC) with the tool CVAT. This alongside the lecture on cropmarks and how to apply a Random Forest algorithm to the spatial and archaeological data, is very beneficial to my further work with Danish data. Furthermore, the short introduction to Meta's DinoV3 proved to be the catalyst for further reading into the subject and Meta's research. The short introduction to Hugging Face also sparked a new interest in the sea of models that appear

on the site, which also led me to read the papers published with each model. While my focus was on remote sensing in computer vision, the other lectures gave me an insightful view into the other applications of computer vision in archaeology.

As for the social happenings throughout the week, it was a great introduction to how the evenings are spent in Brno and the institute. The social events, the city walk and the tour of the institute's laboratory proved fun and engaging. The event with catering for the group created a pleasant atmosphere to network with peers and ask further questions about their work. For me, this was an unexpected bonus to listen and talk about the different roles of archaeology across universities in Europe, as I have only attended conferences and seminars in Scandinavia. The city walk highlighted Brno's deep historical roots in the medieval period in Czechia with some insightful facts, a nice change of pace from the work in the lectures. The tour of the laboratory gave insight into how they handle their artefacts and different approaches to conservation and non-destructive analysis methods. A picture in the lab can be seen below.

To conclude, this training has been valuable for broadening my perspective on computational analysis in archaeology with this course on computer vision. The summer school gave an introductory overview of the different tools available with plenty of opportunities to continue my learning.

